

2c. Content of Studies and applications in psychology 1

This component introduces learners to the following topics: Criminal Psychology, Development and Psychological Problems.

Learners must demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the key concepts, theories/ explanations, related research studies and applications listed.

For the research studies the following must be studied: background, method (design, sample, materials/apparatus, procedure), results, conclusions and criticisms.

Learners are also required to have studied all content relating to planning research, doing research and analysing research (see section 2c Content of Research Methods (Components 01 and 02)).

Learners are encouraged to carry out ethical, investigative practical activities appropriate for the study of psychology at this level, but learners will not be directly assessed on these specific activities.

Criminal Psychology	Content
Key Concepts	• Different types of crime including: violent; drug related; acquisitive; sexual; and anti-social offences • Criminal behaviour as a social construct including deviation from norms and the role of culture in defining criminal/anti-social behaviour • How crime is measured: official statistics and self-report.
Theories/Explanations of why criminal/anti-social behaviour occurs The Social Learning Theory	• The Social Learning Theory of Criminality: ◦ identification with role models ◦ the role of observation and imitation ◦ the process of vicarious reinforcement ◦ the role of direct reinforcement and internalisation ◦ criticisms of the theory including the nature/nurture debate. Social Learning Theory Research Study – Cooper and Mackie (1986): Study into video games and aggression in children.
Eysenck's Criminal Personality Theory	• Eysenck's Criminal Personality Theories (1964 and 1992) and the Biological Basis of Personality (1967) • extraversion; neuroticism; and psychoticism; in relation to criminal behaviour • <u>how the central nervous system relates to cognitions and behaviour, with specific reference to arousal levels and the criminal personality</u> • <u>how functions of the brain relate to cognitions and behaviour with specific reference to synapses and dopaminergic neurons and how they interact in an overactive dopamine system in psychoticism</u> • <u>the role of dopamine reward systems; the reticular activation system and the cerebral cortex in extroversion</u> • <u>the role of the autonomic nervous and the limbic system in neuroticism</u>